10 Writing layouts and components

This chapter covers

- Writing a custom legend component
- Writing a custom grid layout
- Adding functionality to make layout and component settings customizable
- Adding interactivity to components

Throughout this book, we've dealt with D3 components and layouts. In this chapter we'll write them. After you've created your own layout and your own component, you'll more clearly understand the structure and function of layouts. You'll also be able to use that layout, and other layouts that you create on your own later, in the charts that you build with D3.

In this chapter we'll create a custom layout that places a dataset on a grid. For most of the chapter, we'll use our tweets dataset, but the advantage of a layout is that the particular dataset doesn't matter. The purpose of this chapter isn't to create a grid, but rather to help you understand how layouts work. We'll create a grid layout because it's simple and allows us to focus on layout structure rather than the particulars of any data visualization layout. We'll follow that up by extending the layout so it can have a set size that we can change. You'll also see how the layout